

Delaware County Commissioners Meeting August 21st 2023

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=1o1T4z1wZoY
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Delaware County Commissioners Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: August 21, 2023

Start Time: 9:03 AM

1. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Opening:** Presided over by the President of the Delaware County Commissioners. The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance.
- **Attendance:**
 - Members Present: Recorded via roll call as Commissioners King, Reagan, and Henry.
 - Presiding Officer: Board President.
 - Members Absent: None noted.

2. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Opened with the Pledge of Allegiance.
- **Approval of Minutes:** **00:01:51** The minutes of the August 7, 2023 commissioner meeting were approved by roll call vote (Yes: King, Reagan, Henry).

3. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:01:18 Board Appointment Nomination**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board Commissioner.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The board proposed nominating Marianne Poe (from the plan commission) to a specific board, effective until December 31, 2023, allowing an incoming person freedom to make changes later.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Yes: King, Reagan, Henry).
- **00:01:51 Ordinance 2023-017: Extension of Solar Farm Moratorium**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** County Planning / Board.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Second reading of an ordinance to extend the moratorium on solar farms in Delaware County through December 31, 2023, allowing the solar study committee and plan commission time to complete their work and review notes.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:**
 - **00:34:02 Sue Arrington** (representing the League of Women Voters of Muncie and Delaware County) spoke in support of lifting the moratorium once a strong commercial solar ordinance is ready. She inquired about the rollout timeline, noting surrounding counties are advancing renewable energy and pointing out potential state-level readiness incentives (Senate Bill 390 / Indiana Office of Energy Development).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Adopted / Approved by roll call vote (Yes: King, Reagan, Henry).
- **00:15:34 Credible Messenger Program Funding Support**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jeff Hanser, Chief Probation Officer, alongside guest speaker Neil (Community Pastor with Urban Life Community Development).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion regarding youth support, the lack of emergency placement resources for children detained by the Department of Child Services (DCS), and the “Credible Messenger” mentorship program. The program trains community members<U+2014>including individuals with past criminal justice system engagement<U+2014>to act as street mentors for at-risk youth. A 3-day training is scheduled for late September.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** **00:26:09** Motion to allocate \$10,000 from the EDIT (Economic Development Income Tax) account to support the program. Approved by roll call vote (Yes: King, Reagan, Henry).
- **00:27:27 Eaton EMS Ambulance Decommissioning Request**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mike Ashley, Delaware County EMS.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request submitted on behalf of Mike Foster (Eaton EMS) to decommission a 14-year-old 2009 county-purchased ambulance with over 200,000 miles and two replaced engines. The vehicle has reached the end of its operational life.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Yes: King, Reagan, Henry).
 - **00:29:47 Payment of Claims**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** County Administration.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Review and authorization for the payment of county claims totaling \$973,598.56 (with an alternative total read of \$754.68 mentioned in administrative reading).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Yes: King, Reagan, Henry).
 - **00:30:33 Schaefer Leadership Academy County Membership Renewal**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mitch Isaacs and Ted Ward, Schaefer Leadership Academy.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request for the county to renew its presidential-level membership, which grants all county employees unlimited access to virtual and in-person trainings, customized programming, and access to a government board interest system. The academy also offered supplementary board governance and recruitment training.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Yes: King, No: Henry <U+2014> Note: Roll call recorded King (Yes), Reagan (Yes), Henry (No)).
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4. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **00:12:57 John Newby (Delaware County Soil and Water Board):** Announced the development of a new 2023 plat book and an accompanying photo contest (landscapes, wildlife, farm buildings) for county residents. He also highlighted an upcoming annual local work group meeting hosted by district conservationist Wes Slain at the USDA Center on Briarwood to prioritize local conservation needs (such as erosion and invasives) and secure leveraging/federal funding.
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5. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Acknowledged receipt of the Weights and Measures monthly report.
 - Planning Director Brandy provided an update on the solar ordinance timeline, targeting a report by late August, committee review, and a potential Plan Commission public hearing in October 2023.
 - **Adjournment:** **00:40:32** Motion to recess/adjourn passed by roll call vote (Yes: King, Reagan, Henry).
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